Contact ID: HOHContactID
Mastercase: MC
Service Request: SRs

Notice Date

Notice ID: EE415-MM
Questions? Call for free 1-855-899-9600
PRINTDOC **Deaf or hard of hearing?** Call 711

First name, Last name
Address
Address

Medicaid Rules Are Changing in 2027.

You may need to meet new Work Requirements to keep your coverage.

Dear **First Name, Last Name,**

Our records show these household members may need to meet Work Requirements in **2027**:

<NAME>
<NAME>

We're sending this letter now, so you have time to prepare for this change. Keep reading to learn what this means for you.

What are Medicaid Work Requirements?

A new federal law changes how some adults can get or keep Medicaid. You may need to show you worked, were in school or work programs, or completed community service. This is called **Work Requirements**.

Who must meet the Work Requirements?

Most adults under age 65 must meet the requirements to get and keep Medicaid. These adults are called "applicable individuals." Some adults under age 65 have an **exclusion**. An exclusion means the requirements do not apply to them.

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Who does NOT have to meet the Work Requirements?

You will **NOT** have to meet the requirements if **any** of these **exclusions** are true for you:

- Under age 19 or age 65 or older
- Are pregnant now or in postpartum Medicaid coverage (12 months after the pregnancy ends).
- On Medicare or can get Medicare
- A former foster care youth and currently age 19 to 26
- American Indian or Alaska Native
- A parent or family caregiver of a child under age 14
- A veteran with a total disability rating from the Department of Veterans Affairs
- Already meeting 3SquaresVT or Reach Up work requirements
- In a drug or alcohol treatment program
- In prison now or in the past 3 months
- A family caregiver of a person with a disability
- Your physical, mental, or other health condition significantly impairs your ability to meet the Work Requirements. **AND** you:
  - Are blind or disabled
  - Have a substance use disorder
  - Have a disabling mental disorder
  - Have a serious or complex medical condition
  - Have a physical, intellectual, or developmental disability that significantly impairs your ability to do daily life activities

Not sure if the new Work Requirements apply to you? Use our free screening tool at dvha.vermont/gov/medicaid-work-requirements-screening-tool **OR** scan the QR code below:

Scan the QR code



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How do you meet the Work Requirements?

There are two ways to meet the requirements. You only need to meet **one**:

Option 1 — Income

Show that your household got at least $580 in income in a month.

Are you a seasonal worker? Show you earned at least $3,480 in the last 6 months. A seasonal worker is hired for a set time. This is for a few weeks or months at certain times of the year.

Option 2 —School or Hours

Be enrolled in school at least half-time **OR** do at least **80 hours** a month of these activities:

- Work or self-employment
- Community service
- Education or work programs (including GED programs)

You can combine hours from different activities to reach 80.

Short-term hardship exceptions

Adults who must meet the requirements can ask for a hardship **exception**. A hardship exception means the requirements do NOT apply to them for a short time.

You can ask for a hardship exception if one of the following are true for you:

- **You were admitted to extended care since your last renewal.** This includes getting care in a hospital, nursing home, or psychiatric hospital. It also includes care in an intermediate care facility for people with intellectual disabilities. It can include getting out-patient services while living at home.

- **You traveled for a serious or complex medical condition since your last renewal.** This may be traveling to get care for yourself or a dependent. The needed care must not be available where you live. The travel is for an extended period.

When will we check that you met the Work Requirements?

We'll start to check at your first renewal in **2027** using information we already have. We'll check that you met the requirements in at least one of the last 12 months. After your first renewal in 2027, you will have to renew your Medicaid every 6 months. We will check that you met the requirements in at least one of the last 6 months.

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What happens if you do NOT meet the Work Requirements?

- **Your Medicaid coverage may end**. You can re-apply at any time.
- If you lose Medicaid for not meeting Work Requirements, you **cannot** get help paying for a Qualified Health Plan. This help is called Advance Premium Tax Credits.

Steps you can take now to get ready for the Work Requirements

✅ **Update your contact information** so we can reach you. Call us or log in at **VermontHealthConnect.gov**.

✅ **Report any changes** in your income, job, or household (like a new baby, marriage, or divorce). Here's how to report changes:

- **Call:** **1-855-899-9600**
- **Online:** **VermontHealthConnect.gov**
- **Mail:** Department of Vermont Health Access
  Application and Document Processing Center
  280 State Drive, NOB 1 South, Waterbury, VT 05671-8100

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✅ **Plan ahead** if you think you'll need to meet the requirements. Look into work, education, or community service options now.

- For work or work program ideas, go to **www.vermontjoblink.com**.
- For education ideas, go to **education.vermont.gov/student-learning/adult-education.**
- For community service ideas, call the United Way for free at **211 OR** go to **vermont211.org/volunteer-with-vermont-211**.

✅ **Keep records** of your income or your work, education, or community service hours. You may need these at your renewal. **If we need more information, we may ask for:**

- Pay stubs
- Community service logs
- School records or transcripts
- Proof that you took part in a work program

Looking for help with the Work Requirements? Check **<Work Requirements Help URL>** to find work, work programs, education, or community service options near you.

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Questions? We're here to help.

Call us free: 1-855-899-9600 (Monday–Friday, 8 a.m.–4:30 p.m., except holidays)

Online: dvha.vermont.gov/medicaidchanges

Free in-person help: Find a trained Assister at info.healthconnect.vermont.gov/find-local-help/find or call us and ask for an Assister.

Free legal help: Office of the Health Care Advocate —**1-800-917-7787** or www.vtlawhelp.org

Thank you,
Vermont Health Connect Customer Service

Rights of People with Disabilities

Is it hard for you to do the things we ask you to do? We can make changes to help you. Changes are called "reasonable accommodations" under the ADA (Americans with Disabilities Act).
Here are some of the changes we can make:

- Someone can write down your answers if you can't.
- We can give you more time.
- We can help you get papers you need to give us.
- You can have a support person with you when you talk to us.
- We can send you papers in large print.

Do you need **any** changes to help you? Tell us by calling **1-855-899-9600** for free.